

Introduction

Like most good books, we wanted to start this one with a captivating story. But instead, we're going to start it with an email. It's *the* email that changed the course of our lives and set the wheels in motion for the book you're now holding. It came to us from a listener of the *Frugal Friends* podcast who said:

Hi,

I'm just starting out and feel like I'm failing miserably at my frugal journey. Maybe my problem is that I have too much fun buying things. Not just things but experiences too. Recently, you mentioned being frugal can be really fun, but I'd love to know HOW? I have student loan debt, no real savings, and I'm thinking more and more that just owning a home might be an unattainable goal. I love my job as a teacher, but there are no prospects for any significant pay increases so I NEED to be more frugal.

But I also don't want to stop living my life just for the sake of saving. I'm sick of feeling like wanting to shop is a bad thing and that all my financial shortcomings are my fault. I don't think being better at budgeting or buying fewer lattes is the answer, trust me I've tried that. I want to enjoy my life, but I do fear I'm screwing myself over in the long run.

Do you have a podcast episode about ways being frugal is fun, or ways we can make it as fun as buying things is? I've learned so much from you and have put a lot of your advice in place, but I can't say I find being frugal fun. And I need it to be.

*Thanks!
Amber*

This email highlighted pain points around money so many of us experience. And it challenged us to take a deeper look at some of the difficulties we face in getting the things we want and need while still enjoying our lives. We knew that like Amber, people don't typically see